I forecast the

FIFA World Cup 2026

before a ball was kicked.

Here is the report card —
misses included.

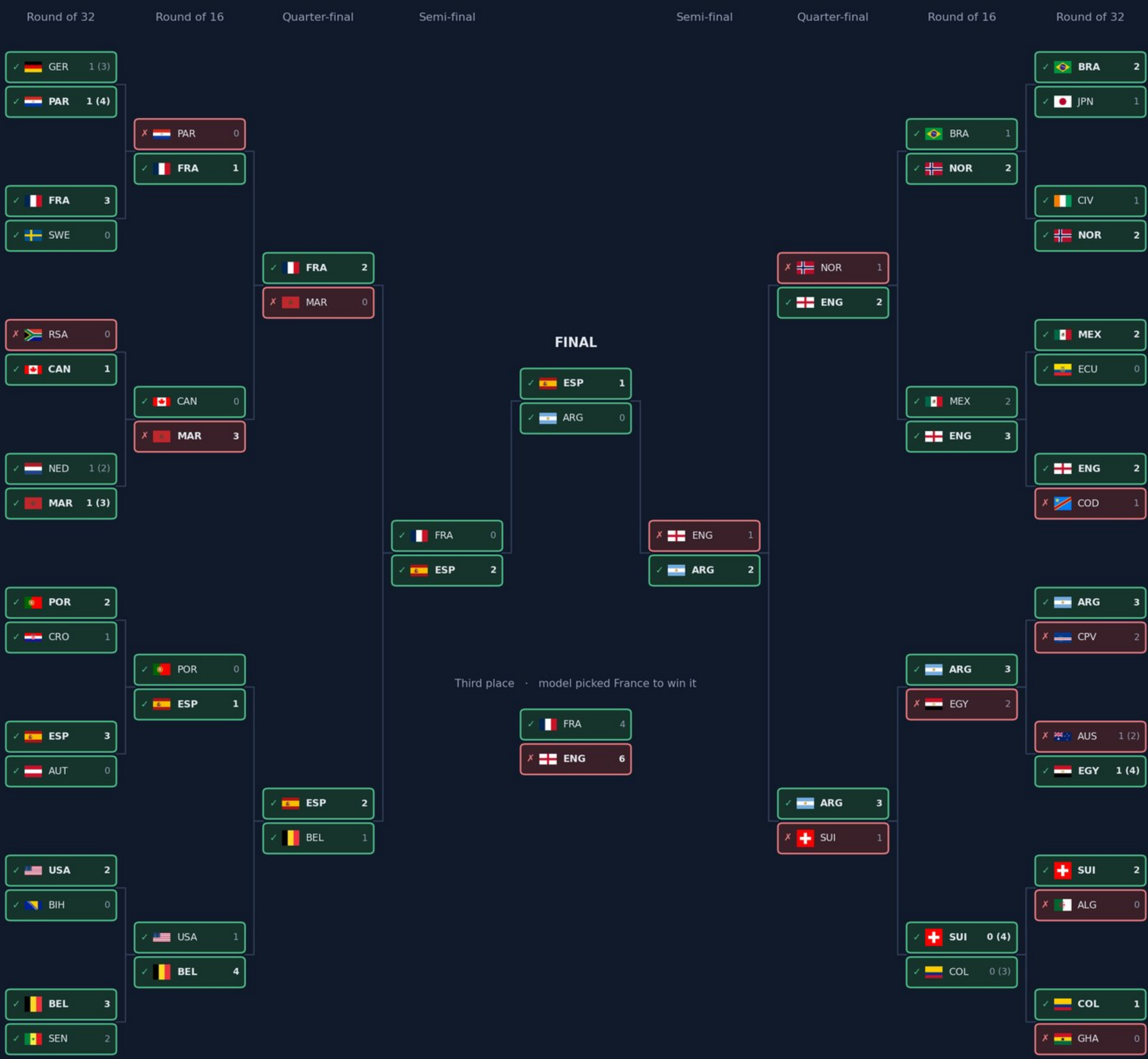
Elo-driven Dixon–Coles Poisson model

10,000 simulations

FIFA World Cup 2026 — what my model got right

Poisson + Elo model, predictions locked before a ball was kicked. Every team box marked against what the model predicted for that round.

✓ model had this team reaching this round   ✗ it did not

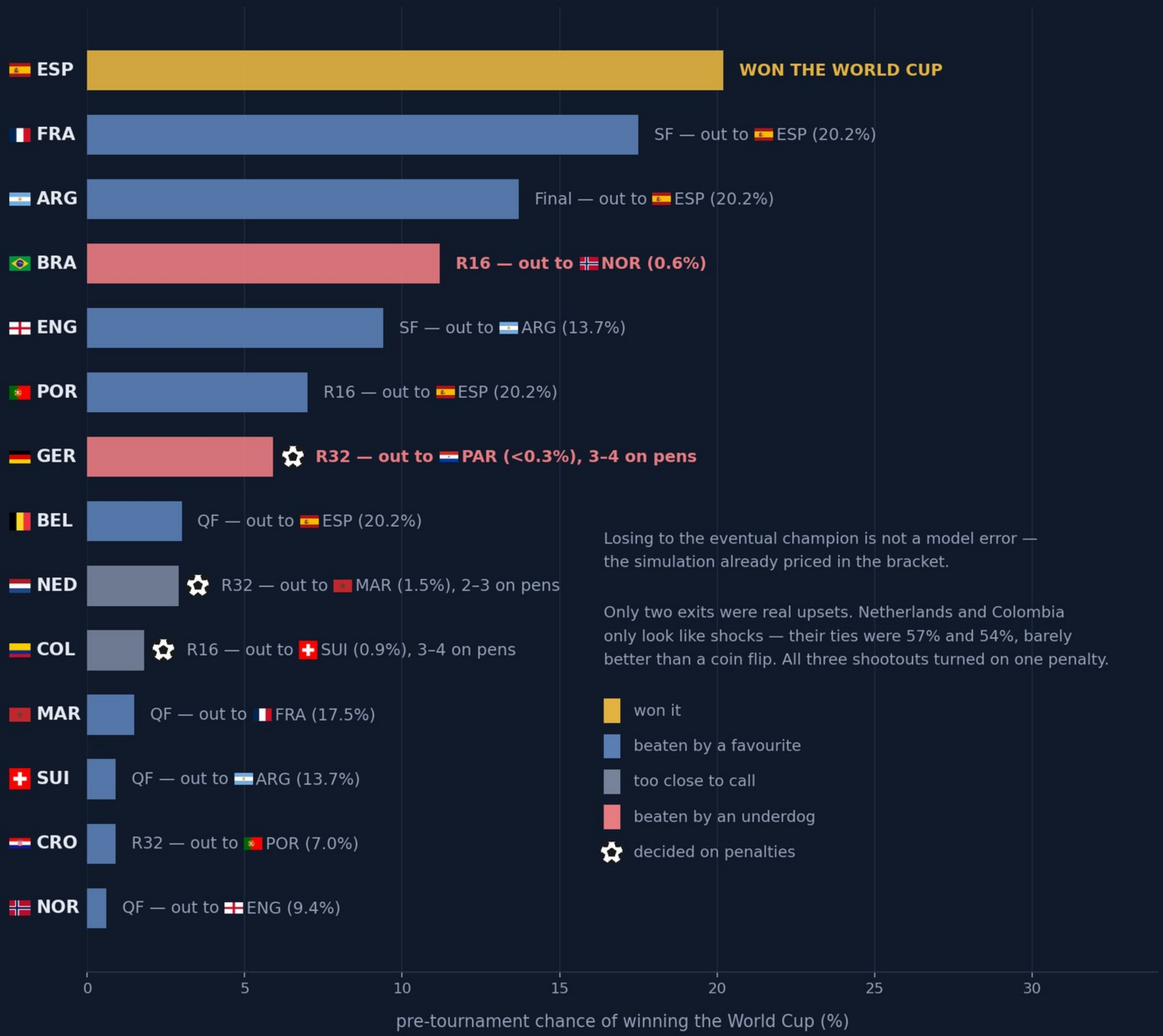


Last 32: 26/32 · Last 16: 13/16 · Last 8: 5/8 · Last 4: 3/4 · Final: 2/2

Third place: England ✗ · Champion: Spain ✓

Beaten by a favourite — or by an underdog?

Bars = title chance over 10,000 pre-tournament simulations. Labels = how the run ended, and who ended it.



It called 10 ties too close to call

Barely better than a coin flip, said the model.

✓	Spain to beat France	52%
✓	Spain to beat Argentina	54%
✗	Colombia to beat Switzerland	54%
✗	Ecuador to beat Mexico	54%
✓	Egypt to beat Australia	55%
✓	Argentina to beat England	55%
✗	Netherlands to beat Morocco	57%
✗	France to beat England	57%
✓	Switzerland to beat Algeria	57%
✓	Norway to beat Ivory Coast	60%

6 right. 4 wrong.

About what a coin flip should look like.

What I'd change

Penalties

Two of my four biggest misses went to a shootout.
A goals model has nothing to say about those.

Confidence

It was consistently underconfident — the probabilities were too timid, not too bold.

Draw luck

Losing to the eventual champion isn't an error.
Judge a forecast by who beat you, not where you finished.

Every prediction was committed to git before kick-off.

The timestamps are the proof.

github.com/Ganapathy-K/fifa-world-cup-2026-forecast